3.4.2 COPD (Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease)

This is characterized by progressive airflow limitation that is not fully reversible. It includes chronic bronchitis, pulmonary emphysema and bronchial asthma.

Chronic bronchitis, is a chronic inflammation of the lower respiratory tract characterized by excessive mucous secretion, cough, and dyspnea associated with recurring infections of lower respiratory tract.

Pulmonary emphysema, is a complex lung disease characterized by destruction of the alveoli enlargement of distal air space, and break down of alveolar walls.

Causes

1. Cigarette smoking
2. Air pollution
3. Occupational exposure
4. Allergy
5. Autoimmunity
6. Infection
7. Genetic predisposition
8. Aging

Signs & Symptoms

Chronic bronchitis

- Productive cough
- Production of thick gelatinous sputum
- Wheezing and dyspnea

Emphysema

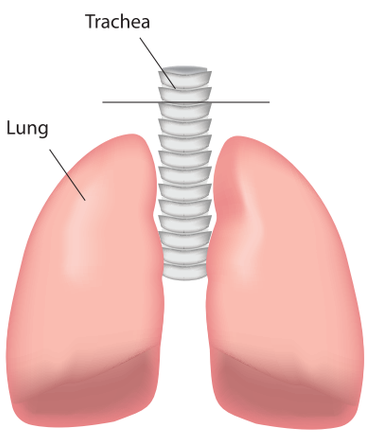
- Dyspnea
- Decreased exercise tolerance
- Minimal cough with mild expectoration
- Barrel chest

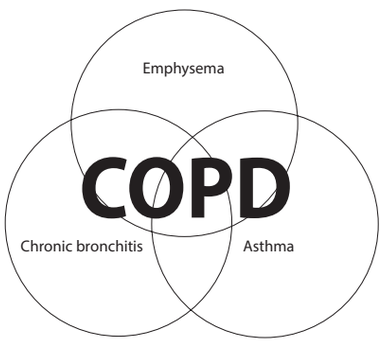
Investigations

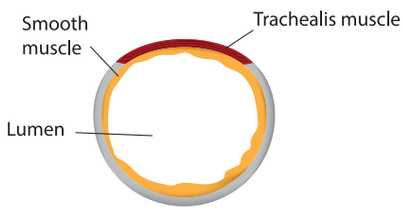
- PFT – Pulmonary function Test
- ABG levels
- Chest X ray

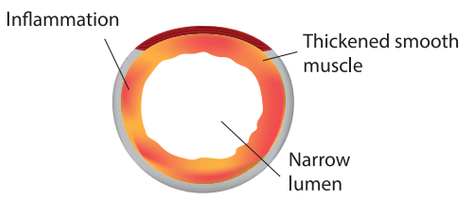
Management

- Cessation of smoking
- Inhaled bronchodilators
- Inhaled and or oral corticosteroids
- Chest physiotherapy









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